25 — The monthly client report

The thing the client actually receives. One page a month that makes the fee obvious.

Read this before using anything below

Klyara **cannot trade as a bookkeeper by way of business until AML supervision is in place** (docs/01, docs/06 §5). Everything in this document that offers, prices or sells the service is written for the day supervision lands. Before then, run the education-first and waitlist variants in docs/03 — the content, the guides and the free tools are all fine to publish now; the **"we do your books for £X a month" half is not**. Ask a client for a review only after you have lawfully done work for them. Delete this box on the day the licence arrives, and not before.

In this part

The thing the client actually receives. One page a month that makes the fee obvious.

Why this matters more than it looks

A bookkeeping client cannot see the work. The bank gets reconciled, the return gets filed, the statements go out — and from the client's chair, nothing visibly happened. That is the whole retention problem in this trade, and it is why people leave a perfectly good bookkeeper for £30 a month.

The monthly report is the fix. It is the only regular, tangible thing they get, and it is the reason they can answer "what do you actually pay them for?" when a mate on site asks.

Template: assets/sales/Klyara-Monthly-Client-Report-TEMPLATE.pdf — three pages, on brand, filled with a worked example so you can see the shape before you build your first real one.

The line that matters

Template: assets/sales/Klyara-Monthly-Client-Report-TEMPLATE.pdf — three pages, on brand, filled with a worked example so you can see the shape before you build your first real one.

Also worth knowing

It is the only regular, tangible thing they get, and it is the reason they can answer "what do you actually pay them for?" when a mate on site asks.

The rules

Out by the fourth working day. Every month. Without exception.

Late is worse than short. A client who gets a two-line email on day four beats one who gets a beautiful report on day fifteen, because by day fifteen they have already made every decision the report was meant to inform.

It is a summary, not a set of accounts. Three pages maximum. If it needs a fourth page, the fourth page is a phone call.

Every number has a "so what" attached. £14,380 of retentions is a fact. "£14,380 is tied up, and £5,200 of it is releasable before 31 March — put those two dates in your phone" is the report doing its job.

Never send it without reading it yourself first. You will catch the wrong month, the missing invoice, and the figure that cannot be right. The client should never be the first person who looks at it properly.

The line that matters

Out by the fourth working day. Every month. Without exception.



Also worth knowing

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What goes on each page

Page 1 — the month

Four headline figures across the top: **turnover, gross margin, profit, cash in the bank.** Those four, in that order, always. They are the only four numbers most clients will read, so put them where the eye lands first and make them large.

Then the profit shape, in five lines: turnover, cost of sales, gross profit, overheads, profit. Not a full P&L. Five lines.

Then **what they owe and when** — VAT, CIS, PAYE, suppliers, each with the date. And under it, the single most useful sentence in the whole report:

> **Set aside £X before anything else comes out of the account this month.**
>
> and the PAYE. It is not your money and it has dates attached.

That sentence has saved more small builders than any piece of tax advice, and it is a sentence you can only write if you did the bookkeeping.

Page 2 — what they are owed, and CIS

Debtors, retentions held, and then the part that earns the fee: **the three customers to ring, in order, with what to say to each one.**

Biggest and oldest at the top. One line of instruction each. Not a debtor report — a call list.

Then CIS: subcontractors paid, how many verified before payment, deducted at 20% and at 30%, when the return was filed, when the statements went out. This month and year to date.

The "worth knowing" box under it is where you tell them the thing they would not have noticed — a subbie who moved from 30% to 20%, a clean twelve months that qualifies them for gross payment status, a supplier who has started reverse charging incorrectly.

Page 3 — retentions, and three things to do

Every retention with its release date and status, then **three actions.** Exactly three. Not five, not a list of everything outstanding.

Three is enough to be useful and few enough to be done. A list of eleven things gets read as a complaint and actioned as nothing.

Each one is specific enough to do without thinking:

> **Ring [Customer A] about the £4,300. It is 31 days out and it is the bi**
>
> page.

Not "improve credit control".

> **The line that matters**
>
> the three customers to ring, in order, with what to say to each one.

How to fill it in, in about twenty minutes

Do this in the same sitting as the month-end close, while the numbers are in your head.

#	STEP	TIME
1	Pull the four headline figures and last month's turnover for the comparison	2 min
2	Five-line profit shape from the P&L	2 min
3	Tax liabilities and their dates. Add them up for the set-aside sentence	3 min
4	Debtor list. Pick the three to chase and write one line of instruction each	5 min
5	CIS figures, this month and year to date, straight off the return	2 min
6	Retention schedule — amounts, dates, and anything overdue	2 min
7	Write the three actions. This is the bit that is actually worth the fee	4 min

Step 7 is the whole job. Steps 1 to 6 are data entry and could in principle be automated. Step 7 is a person who knows the business looking at it and saying what to do. Never skip it, never generalise it, and never write the same three things two months running — if nothing changed, say that instead and say why.

The line that matters

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Also worth knowing

Do this in the same sitting as the month-end close, while the numbers are in your head.

Which tiers get it

TIER	WHAT THEY GET	WHEN
Solo	One page: invoiced, received, CIS deducted	4th working day
Start	One page, plus the VAT position in a VAT quarter	4th working day
Trade	The full three pages	4th working day
Pro	The full three pages, plus job-by-job margin and a written commentary	4th working day

Solo and Start get a genuinely shorter version — not the same report with blanks in it. A report with empty sections looks like a service that is not being delivered.

The line that matters

Solo and Start get a genuinely shorter version — not the same report with blanks in it.

The email it goes out with



Keep it three lines. The report is the content; the email is a doorbell.

> ****Subject: [Firm] — October summary****
>
> [Name] — October's attached. Short version: a good month, £7,660 profit, but £9,120 of what you invoiced is overdue and £4,300 of that is 31 days out. Three things to do are on the last page, and the first one is a phone call. Set aside £8,935 for the VAT, CIS and PAYE before anything else comes out. Any questions, ring me. [Name]

Always put the set-aside figure in the email body, not just in the report. Some clients never open the attachment, and that number is the one that stops a bad January.

The two mistakes to avoid

Sending an accountant's report. No jargon, no "creditors falling due within one year", no comparatives to budget when there is no budget. If a line would need explaining on the phone, rewrite it or remove it.

Sending it and going quiet. The report is the trigger for the monthly call, not a replacement for it. On Trade the call is fifteen minutes and it is where the add-on work comes from — every gross payment status application, every payroll setup, every "actually, can you look at…" starts with a client reading page three and picking up the phone.

The line that matters

No jargon, no "creditors falling due within one year", no comparatives to budget when there is no budget.

Also worth knowing

The report is the trigger for the monthly call, not a replacement for it.

Related

- **docs/21** — the tier definitions this report is promised under
- **docs/12** — onboarding, and the first report at the end of month one
- **docs/06** — the operating rhythm the fourth working day sits inside
- assets/sales/Klyara-Monthly-Client-Report-TEMPLATE.pdf — the template, with worked figures
- brand/gen_clientreport.py — edit the figures at the top and re-run to produce a real one

AT A GLANCE

The short version

docs/21 – the tier definitions this repo	docs/12 – onboarding, and the first repo	docs/06 – the operating rhythm the fourt
assets/sales/Klyara-Mo	brand/gen_clientreport.py – edit the fig	

PROGRESS

Part 9 of 9 – Related 100%

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